

D575

Health Psychology

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A 50-year-old bus mechanic who coaches Little League has chronic low back pain. His clinic, which recently won a quality award, plans care that addresses his muscle strength, his fear that movement will cause more damage, and his worry about losing income. Which model guides this plan?

- A. The plan reflects the clinic's quality award criteria.
- B. The health belief model.
- C. The biomedical model.
- D. The biopsychosocial model.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A caregiver who knits blankets for a hospital charity has cared for her husband with dementia for three years. At first she coped well, but now she is constantly exhausted, catches frequent colds, and has trouble recovering. Her daughter lives two states away. Which stage of the general adaptation syndrome best fits?

- A. Alarm.
- B. Exhaustion.
- C. Recovery, since she has adapted after three years.
- D. Resistance.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A driver swerves to avoid a crash; his heart pounds and his hands shake within seconds. Which stage of the general adaptation syndrome is this?

- A. Resistance.
- B. Exhaustion.
- C. Alarm.
- D. Secondary appraisal.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

Two nursing students at a college with a new simulation center get the same surprise assignment to lead a patient safety briefing. One thinks, "This is a chance to show what I can do," and prepares calmly. The other thinks, "This could embarrass me in front of everyone." Both students ride the same bus to campus. At which step do their responses first differ?

- A. Primary appraisal.
- B. The shared bus ride.
- C. The stressor itself, which is different for each.
- D. Secondary appraisal.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A patient newly diagnosed with diabetes thinks, "This is serious, but I have a good care team and I know how to follow a plan." Which appraisal is shown in the second half of her thought, and how does it affect stress?

- A. Secondary appraisal; seeing enough resources lowers stress.
- B. Secondary appraisal; seeing resources raises stress.
- C. Emotion-focused coping.
- D. Primary appraisal; judging the diagnosis as serious lowers stress.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A woman who sings in a church choir is waiting three days for biopsy results, and nothing she does can speed or change them. Her office recently switched to a four-day work week. Which coping approach is most adaptive for this stressor?

- A. Problem-focused coping, which is always the best choice.
- B. Using the extra day off to work longer hours.
- C. Calling the lab repeatedly to demand faster results.
- D. Emotion-focused coping, such as relaxation, seeking support, or reframing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student is stressed about a failing grade that can be raised by retaking two quizzes. Which coping approach fits best?

- A.** Avoid thinking about the class.
- B.** Problem-focused: make a study plan and retake the quizzes.
- C.** Coping cannot affect grades.
- D.** Emotion-focused only: relax and accept the grade.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A 55-year-old who plays golf every weekend says, “I know colon cancer can be deadly, but I don’t have a family history, so it probably won’t happen to me.” He has not scheduled a screening. His golf club recently added a new clubhouse. Which health belief model construct is limiting his action?

- A.** Low perceived severity.
- B.** Low self-efficacy.
- C.** Low perceived susceptibility.
- D.** High perceived barriers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A clinic sends patients a text reminder the week their flu shot is due. Which health belief model construct does the text target?

- A.** Perceived barriers.
- B.** Perceived susceptibility, since every reminder raises perceived risk.
- C.** Cues to action.
- D.** Perceived severity.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A college student who works at a campus coffee shop believes daily exercise is good for her and wants to start. Her close friends and family think it is important. But her schedule is packed, and she does not believe she can fit it in. She lives in a dorm with a small gym. Under the theory of planned behavior, which factor most limits her intention?

- A.** Weak subjective norms.
- B.** Low perceived behavioral control.
- C.** Lack of a gym.
- D.** Negative attitude toward exercise.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A 62-year-old retired firefighter with high blood pressure stops his medication after a month because he “feels fine now” and thinks the problem is cured. His pharmacy offers free delivery. What best explains his nonadherence?

- A.** His illness perception: he sees hypertension as short-term and symptom-based rather than chronic.
- B.** He is right, since feeling fine means blood pressure is controlled.
- C.** Simple forgetfulness.
- D.** Poor access to the medication.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A small-business owner who restores antique furniture has faced months of financial stress and poor sleep. She now gets sick more often and her wounds heal slowly. Her shop is on a quiet street. What physiological process best explains this?

- A.** The alarm stage of acute stress.
- B.** Poor sleep alone, with stress playing no role.
- C.** Chronic stress strengthens immunity, so something else must be wrong.
- D.** Chronic HPA-axis activation and elevated cortisol suppress immune function.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A 50-year-old bus mechanic ~~who coaches Little League~~ has chronic low back pain. His clinic, ~~which recently won a quality award~~, plans care that addresses his muscle strength, his fear that movement will cause more damage, and his worry about losing income. Which model guides this plan?

Target word: model behind the plan **Decides:** Biological, psychological, and social factors addressed together.

A	Camouflage	The award does not define the model used.
B	Adjacent category	A model of health behavior decisions, not an overall model of illness.
C	Dropped element	Would address only the biological factor and drop fear and income.
D	Correct	Strength (bio), fear of movement (psycho), and income worry (social) interact.

2. Answer B Concept 2

A caregiver ~~who knits blankets for a hospital charity~~ has cared for her husband with dementia for three years. At first she coped well, but now she is constantly exhausted, catches frequent colds, and has trouble recovering. ~~Her daughter lives two states away.~~ Which stage of the general adaptation syndrome best fits?

Target word: GAS stage **Decides:** Long-term stress with depleted resources and illness.

A	Inverted operation	Alarm is the initial response at the start of a stressor.
B	Correct	Resources are depleted after prolonged stress, raising illness risk.
C	Absolute language	Time alone does not bring adaptation; her symptoms show depletion.
D	Confusion set	Resistance is the earlier period when she was coping well.

3. Answer C Concept 2 · transfer

A driver swerves to avoid a crash; his heart pounds and his hands shake within seconds. Which stage of the general adaptation syndrome is this?

Target word: stage from an acute response **Decides:** Immediate fight-or-flight activation.

A	Confusion set	Resistance is sustained coping over time.
B	Inverted operation	Exhaustion follows prolonged stress, not seconds.
C	Correct	The immediate sympathetic activation to a new stressor.
D	Adjacent category	A cognitive step in a different model, not a GAS stage.

4. Answer A Concept 3

Two nursing students ~~at a college with a new simulation center~~ get the same surprise assignment to lead a patient safety briefing. One thinks, "This is a chance to show what I can do," and prepares calmly. The other thinks, "This could embarrass me in front of everyone." ~~Both students ride the same bus to campus.~~ At which step do their responses first differ?

Target word: appraisal step **Decides:** Judging the event as challenge vs. threat.

A	Correct	They judge the same event differently—challenge vs. threat.
B	Camouflage	Both share it, so it cannot explain the difference.
C	Dropped element	The assignment is identical; only appraisal differs.
D	Confusion set	Secondary appraisal is judging coping resources; the difference starts earlier.

5. Answer A Concept 3 · transfer

A patient newly diagnosed with diabetes thinks, “This is serious, but I have a good care team and I know how to follow a plan.” Which appraisal is shown in the second half of her thought, and how does it affect stress?

Target word: identify secondary appraisal — reverse direction **Decides:** Judging coping resources as adequate.

A	Correct	Stress rises when demands exceed resources; she sees resources as adequate.
B	Inverted operation	Adequate resources reduce stress.
C	Adjacent category	Coping comes after appraisal; this is the judgment of resources.
D	Confusion set	That is the first half of her thought, and seeing a threat does not lower stress.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A woman ~~who sings in a church choir~~ is waiting three days for biopsy results, and nothing she does can speed or change them. ~~Her office recently switched to a four day work week.~~ Which coping approach is most adaptive for this stressor?

Target word: match coping to controllability **Decides:** The stressor cannot be changed.

A	Absolute language	Problem-focused coping fits controllable stressors.
B	Camouflage	The schedule change does not address this stressor.
C	Inverted operation	Tries to control what cannot be changed, which can raise distress.
D	Correct	When a stressor is uncontrollable, managing emotions fits best.

7. Answer B Concept 4 · transfer

A student is stressed about a failing grade that can be raised by retaking two quizzes. Which coping approach fits best?

Target word: controllable stressor **Decides:** The situation can be changed.

A	Adjacent category	Avoidance does not change the grade.
B	Correct	Acting on a controllable stressor addresses its cause.
C	Absolute language	Problem-focused action can change the outcome here.
D	Inverted operation	Leaves a changeable problem unsolved.

8. Answer C Concept 5

A 55-year-old ~~who plays golf every weekend~~ says, “I know colon cancer can be deadly, but I don’t have a family history, so it probably won’t happen to me.” He has not scheduled a screening. ~~His golf club recently added a new clubhouse.~~ Which health belief model construct is limiting his action?

Target word: HBM construct **Decides:** He doubts he is likely to get it.

A	Confusion set	He says it can be deadly, so severity is high.
B	Dropped element	Nothing suggests doubt about his ability to get screened.
C	Correct	He believes he is unlikely to get the disease.
D	Adjacent category	He names no obstacles to screening.

9. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

A clinic sends patients a text reminder the week their flu shot is due. Which health belief model construct does the text target?

Target word: construct from an intervention — reverse direction **Decides:** A prompt that triggers action.

A	Adjacent category	A reminder does not remove obstacles such as cost or access.
B	Absolute language	A simple reminder prompts action without changing perceived risk.
C	Correct	A reminder is a trigger to act.
D	Confusion set	The text does not address how serious flu is.

10. Answer B Concept 6

A college student ~~who works at a campus coffee shop~~ believes daily exercise is good for her and wants to start. Her close friends and family think it is important. But her schedule is packed, and she does not believe she can fit it in. ~~She lives in a dorm with a small gym.~~ Under the theory of planned behavior, which factor most limits her intention?

Target word: weak component **Decides:** She doubts she can do it.

A	Confusion set	Friends and family support it, so norms are strong.
B	Correct	She doubts she can fit exercise in.
C	Camouflage	Her dorm has a gym; access is not what she doubts.
D	Inverted operation	Her attitude is positive.

11. Answer A Concept 7

A 62-year-old ~~retired firefighter~~ with high blood pressure stops his medication after a month because he “feels fine now” and thinks the problem is cured. ~~His pharmacy offers free delivery.~~ What best explains his nonadherence?

Target word: cause of nonadherence **Decides:** He views the illness as short-term and symptom-driven.

A	Correct	People stop treatment when their illness model says it is resolved.
B	Inverted operation	Hypertension is usually symptomless.
C	Adjacent category	He stopped on purpose, based on a belief.
D	Camouflage	Free delivery shows access is not the issue.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A small-business owner ~~who restores antique furniture~~ has faced months of financial stress and poor sleep. She now gets sick more often and her wounds heal slowly. ~~Her shop is on a quiet street.~~ What physiological process best explains this?

Target word: mechanism linking chronic stress and illness **Decides:** Prolonged cortisol elevation suppresses immunity.

A	Confusion set	Her stress has lasted months, not seconds.
B	Dropped element	Drops the stress pathway that also drives immune suppression.
C	Inverted operation	Brief stress can boost some immune responses; chronic stress suppresses them.
D	Correct	Long-term cortisol exposure weakens immune responses and slows healing.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	8	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Biopsychosocial vs. biomedical model	The biomedical model explains illness by biological causes alone; the biopsychosocial model holds that biological, psychological, and social factors interact to shape health and illness.	Calling a plan biopsychosocial because it includes several biological tests.	Whether mood, beliefs, relationships, or social conditions are part of the explanation.
2	General adaptation syndrome	Under prolonged stress the body moves through alarm (fight-or-flight activation), resistance (sustained coping and arousal), and exhaustion (resources depleted, illness risk rises).	Placing illness vulnerability in the alarm stage.	How long the stressor has lasted and whether the body is still coping.
3	Primary and secondary appraisal	In the transactional model, primary appraisal asks “Is this a threat, harm, or challenge?”; secondary appraisal asks “Do I have the resources to cope?” Stress results when demands seem to exceed resources.	Thinking stress is set by the event alone rather than by appraisal.	Two people reacting differently to the same event.
4	Problem-focused vs. emotion-focused coping	Problem-focused coping acts on the stressor and works best when it is controllable; emotion-focused coping manages feelings and fits best when the stressor cannot be changed.	Believing problem-focused coping is always better.	Whether the person can change the situation.
5	Health belief model	Health behavior is predicted by perceived susceptibility, perceived severity, perceived benefits, perceived barriers, cues to action, and self-efficacy.	Mixing up susceptibility (how likely) and severity (how serious).	A person’s stated reason for acting or not acting on a health recommendation.
6	Theory of planned behavior	Intention—shaped by attitudes toward the behavior, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control—is the most direct predictor of behavior.	Treating subjective norms as the person’s own attitude.	What important others think, and whether the person feels able to do it.
7	Illness perceptions and adherence	People act on their own model of an illness (identity, cause, timeline, consequences, control); if they see a condition as short-term or symptom-driven, they often stop treatment when they feel well.	Assuming nonadherence is simply forgetfulness or defiance.	Stopping medication because symptoms disappeared.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Chronic stress and the body	Chronic stress keeps the HPA axis and cortisol elevated; over time this wear (allostatic load) suppresses immune function and raises the risk of cardiovascular and other chronic disease.	Assuming long-term stress strengthens immunity the way brief stress can.	Months of ongoing stress followed by frequent illness.

Course scope (public description): Health Psychology provides a basic overview of the biopsychosocial model of health and other holistic models of wellness. The course draws from diverse cultural perspectives as well as the theory and practice of human health behavior change to explore the relationship between psychosocial experiences and health. Topics include the impact of social and cultural factors on health, the relationship between stress and physical health and disease, the psychological experience of illness, and how lifestyle patterns and behavior influence chronic disease. There are no prerequisites for this course.